

COPILOT STUDIO · MODERN BUILD-ALONG

Operational Intelligence

Turn scattered incident logs into governed, explainable action

Most organisations have incident data, but it is scattered, inconsistent and under-used. In this build-along you create an agent that turns incident logs into operational insight, helping teams move from reactive reporting to faster triage, better governance and clearer management action. It is deliberately cross-industry: whether you work in banking, medtech, construction, facilities, regulation, insurance, retail or circular-economy operations, the pattern is the same. You build once, then point it at your own incident data.

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You are building on the new Copilot Studio experience

This session uses the redesigned, natural-language-first authoring model, not the older topics-and-branching approach. You describe the agent in plain language and configure it from the **Build** tab.

The modern experience

What today uses

Describe the agent in natural language. Configure it from the Build tab: instructions, knowledge, Microsoft IQ, skills, tools, connected agents, model choice and memory.

The classic approach

Not this session

Manually authored topics, trigger phrases and branching logic. Still available, but no longer the starting point for most new agents.

One pattern, every sector

The agent is not an IT-only helpdesk bot. It is an operational intelligence agent that flexes to your industry:

Your sector	Example incident angle
Banking & finance	Operational risk, service disruption, control incidents
Medtech & animal health	Quality, compliance, production and safety events
Construction & engineering	Site safety, project delivery, NCRs, contractor incidents
Facilities & services	Service issues, facilities incidents, customer escalations
Insurance operations	Claims and process exceptions
Retail & supply chain	Product quality and supply-chain incidents
Regulation & public bodies	Regulatory queries, inspection observations, case tracking
Circular-economy / scheme ops	Depot, vendor and customer escalation incidents
Social housing	Tenant service delivery, facilities and compliance issues

Before We Start

Download the build-along pack, the incident register, triage policy and example reports, from the Codec partner-session folder on GitHub, then have the files ready to upload:

github.com/bosh345/Agent_Build_Alone/blob/main/Partner_Sessions/Codec

- 1 The incident register (CSV or Excel): a row per incident with ID, date reported, business area, site, category, severity, status, summary, root cause, customer impact, estimated cost, corrective action, owner and due date.
- 2 The incident policy / triage guide: severity definitions, escalation rules, SLA expectations and reporting thresholds.
- 3 The example incident reports: eight short write-ups that expand on entries in the register.
- 4 Access to Copilot Studio with the new agent experience enabled. Your presenter will confirm this at the start.

PART 1 OF 7 · CREATE THE AGENT

You will build this agent by hand, one part of the Build tab at a time, so you understand what each piece does. There is a faster natural-language shortcut, and you will try it at the end once you know the moving parts.

1 Create and name the agent

In Copilot Studio, select **Create**, then **New agent**. If a chat-style setup appears, choose to **configure it yourself** or **skip** so you land in the **Build** tab. Set the name to **Operational Intelligence**.

PART 2 OF 7 · SET THE INSTRUCTIONS

Instructions define the agent's identity, tone, scope and behaviour. This is the heart of the Build tab.

2 Open Instructions and paste the brief

In the **Build** tab, open **Instructions** and paste this, then adjust to suit your data:

You are Operational Intelligence.

Your role is to help operational, compliance, service and technology teams understand incident logs and related incident reports.

Use the uploaded incident register, incident reports and triage policy as your primary source of truth.

When responding:

- Be concise, practical and evidence-led.
- Where possible, reference the Incident ID, severity, category, owner and due date.
- Identify patterns across incidents, not just individual records.
- Highlight overdue, high-severity or repeat incidents.
- Recommend next-best actions based on the triage policy.
- If data is missing, say what is missing rather than guessing.
- Do not invent incidents, owners, financial impact or root causes.
- For management summaries, use a clear executive tone with actions and risks.

PART 3 OF 7 · GROUND IT IN YOUR INCIDENT DATA

3 Add your knowledge sources

Open **Knowledge** and add the sample pack: the incident register, the triage policy and the example reports. The new experience supports uploaded files, SharePoint and websites, so you can point at a live incident library later instead of static files.

4 Test the grounding

Ask a few retrieval questions to confirm the agent is answering from your data, not guessing:

Summarise the top five current incident risks and explain why they matter.
Which categories have the most repeat incidents?
Show all high-severity incidents that are still open or overdue.

PART 4 OF 7 · ADD A REUSABLE SKILL

A skill is a modular, reusable set of instructions you can add to this agent and share with others. Here you package the triage logic once.

5 Create the triage skill

Open **Skills** and add a skill. Give it a name and a description, then paste the instructions:

Skill name: incidenttriage

Description: Classifies an incident by severity using the triage policy and returns a recommended severity, reasoning, owner, follow-up action and whether to escalate.

When asked to triage an incident, classify it using the incident severity policy. Consider customer impact, operational disruption, compliance exposure, recurrence, and whether the incident is overdue. Return the result as:

1. Recommended severity
2. Reasoning
3. Recommended owner or team
4. Follow-up action
5. Escalation required: Yes/No

PART 5 OF 7 · ADD A TOOL TO TAKE ACTION

Tools let the agent do something, not just answer. Here you add a tool that is native to Microsoft 365: sending an email from Outlook, so the agent can draft an incident summary and email it.

6 Add a native Outlook email action

Open **Tools**, select **Add a tool**, then the **Office 365 Outlook** connector, and choose **Send an email (V2)**. Sign in with your work account when prompted. Give the tool a description first so the model knows when to call it, then map the three inputs it fills from the conversation:

Description: Email an incident summary to a named recipient.

To: the recipient. Send it to yourself so you can try it safely.

Subject: a short line the agent writes, for example "Escalation: INC-0128 Critical service disruption".

Body: the incident summary the agent generates from the register.

Then try it live:

Email me a summary of the overdue high-severity incidents, grouped by owner.

Outlook is only the easy starting point. The same Tools panel reaches other connectors, Power Automate flows, MCP servers and REST APIs when you are ready to wire the agent into your own systems.

PART 6 OF 7 · MODERN EXTENSIONS (OPTIONAL)

If your tenant and permissions allow, you can add these optional extensions. They are preview features, so treat them as experimental and not for production use.

Optional · Microsoft IQ (preview)

Microsoft IQ gives the agent access to organisational context: emails, calendar events, files, Teams messages and people, all under the signed-in user's existing permissions. Try it with:
Find recent Teams messages, files or meetings related to this incident ID and summarise the latest known status.

Optional · Memory (preview)

Memory lets the agent remember details across interactions, stored separately per user and per agent. Teach it a preference, then rely on it:

Remember that I prefer board summaries in three sections: risk, impact and recommended action.

Create a board summary for the current high-severity incidents.

PART 7 OF 7 · TEST, PUBLISH AND SHARE

7 Preview with the live prompts

Open **Preview** and work through the sample prompts below. Watch how the agent grounds each answer in your data, calls the triage skill, and references Incident IDs, owners and due dates.

8 Publish and share

When you are happy, **Publish** and enable the channels your users live in, such as Microsoft Teams or the Microsoft 365 Copilot app. Review authentication, content moderation and your DLP policy before real users arrive, so the agent runs under the right identity and permissions.

Try these live · sample prompts to work through

Give me a one-page summary of the current incident register.

Which incidents need escalation and why?

Identify three patterns across the incident data.

Show me overdue corrective actions grouped by owner.

Create a 30/60-day improvement plan based on these incidents.

Draft an executive update for the leadership team in Word.

Email me a summary of the current high-severity incidents.

Now try this · the natural-language shortcut

You built the agent by hand, so you now know what each part of the Build tab does. Here is the fast way to scaffold the same thing: start a new agent, and instead of configuring it yourself, describe it in plain language and let Copilot Studio draft the name, description and starting configuration for you. Then refine it using everything you just learned.

Create an operational intelligence agent that helps business users analyse incident logs, identify patterns, triage severity, summarise operational impact, and recommend follow-up actions. The agent should be concise, evidence-led, and only use the provided incident data and policy documents.

The shortcut gets you a starting point in seconds. The manual build you just did is what lets you shape it well.

You've built Operational Intelligence ✓

You now have a working agent that can:

- Answer questions over incident logs and policies
- Triage incidents using a reusable skill
- Spot patterns, repeat issues and overdue actions
- Produce an executive-ready summary
- Recommend next-best actions
- Optionally use Microsoft IQ, memory or a workflow action

Thank you for joining today's session. Whatever your sector, the pattern is the same: turn scattered operational data into governed, explainable action. Reach out to your Microsoft or Codec contact to take it further.